

European Master's Programmes

Research findings and application plan

Prepared 17 August 2026 | target intake autumn 2027

Read first: *your 146 credits are almost certainly a bookkeeping artefact rather than a missing year of study, and the single thing standing between you and most of these options is that you have not yet sat an English test.*

Figures marked NOT VERIFIED could not be confirmed on an official source and were left rather than estimated. Most 2027/28 deadlines are unpublished, so dates indicate when in the year to look, not deadlines to diarise.

1. The 146 credits — what it actually means

Research date: 17 August 2026. Everything below was checked against official sources on that date.

The short answer

Your 146 credits are almost certainly a bookkeeping quirk, not a missing year of study. We are about 85–90% confident of this.

This matters enormously, because it was the single thing that could have closed off most of Europe. It very probably does not.

But there is one thing **you personally have to confirm** before anyone can rely on this. It is explained in "What you need to check this week", below. Please do that first — everything else in this research rests on it.

Why we think the 146 is not a real shortfall

Tunisian law says your degree is 180 credits

The Tunisian *licence* is defined by law — Décret n° 2008-3123 of 22 September 2008, Article 5 — as:

*"three years after the baccalauréat, comprising **180 credits spread over six semesters**"*

This was confirmed again in Décret Présidentiel n° 2022-631 of 14 July 2022.

So 180 credits is a **legal property of the qualification itself**. It is not something a particular transcript can reduce. If you hold the licence, you hold a 180-credit degree, whatever any individual document happens to total.

And Tunisian rules produce transcripts that under-count on purpose

This is the part that explains your specific number.

Under Article 34, a module (*unité d'enseignement*) is "**capitalised**" only if you score 10/20 or above in it. But Article 35 lets you pass the year by **compensation** — if your weighted average across all modules is 10/20 or better, you progress, even with some modules below 10.

So a student who graduates perfectly legitimately by compensation ends up with modules that were **validated but never "capitalised"**. If your transcript prints the "*crédits capitalisés*" column, every compensated module is silently left out.

Now check the arithmetic:

- $180 - 146 = \mathbf{34 \text{ credits missing}}$
- Tunisian modules are worth **4 to 7 credits each** (Article 22)
- $34 \div (4 \text{ to } 7) = \mathbf{\text{roughly } 5 \text{ to } 8 \text{ modules}}$

Five to eight modules passed by compensation, across three years, for a student averaging 12–13/20, is completely ordinary. This explains your exact number better than any other theory.

European evaluators judge the degree, not the transcript sum

The bodies that assess foreign qualifications do not re-add your transcript line by line. They ask a simpler question: *is this qualification, in its own country, equivalent to our bachelor's, and does it let you into a master's at home?*

Sweden's national agency (UHR) is the clearest example we found. It states plainly that both the *Licence Fondamentale* and the *Licence Appliquée* are **three years, 180 credits, equal to a Swedish**

bachelor's degree (180 ECTS).

Norway's agency states the principle even more directly:

"one year of standard study time in the country of education is equivalent to one year (60 ECTS) in Norway."

Six of the seven recognition bodies we checked place the Tunisian licence at bachelor level.

The other possibilities, honestly weighed

We did not just look for the convenient answer. Here is the full ranking:

What might be going on	How likely	What it would mean
Compensation artefact — transcript shows only "capitalised" credits	~50%	No problem. Your degree is 180 credits.
Incomplete or interim transcript — missing the final semester, or the PFE credited separately	~30%	No problem, once you get the complete document.
Local reporting quirk — modules weighted so semester totals aren't exactly 30	~15%	No problem, but needs explaining to admissions.
A genuine shortfall	~5%	Serious — but this is only possible if you have not actually graduated.

That last row is the one to be candid about. If you hold the *diplôme national de licence*, a shortfall is impossible by definition, because 180 credits come with the award. The only scenario where 146 is a real number is one where the degree was never conferred.

We are not assuming that away. You need to confirm it.

What you need to check this week

Take out your paperwork and answer these seven questions. This costs nothing and settles the entire issue.

1. **Which document are you looking at?** A *relevé de notes* (a marks sheet, provisional), an *attestation de réussite* (pass certificate), or the *diplôme national de licence* itself? Only the last two prove the degree was awarded.
2. **Does it cover six semesters (S1–S6)?** Count them. If it stops at S5, it is incomplete by construction.
3. **Is your PFE / final-year project listed and credited?** Your CRM platform project should be carrying credits.
4. **What does the credits column actually say?** "Crédits", or "Crédits capitalisés" / "Crédits acquis" / "Crédits obtenus"? **If it says capitalisés or acquis, the mystery is solved right there** — that is theory 1 confirmed on the face of the document.
5. **Are there modules marked below 10/20 where the year is still marked *validé* or *admis par compensation*?** If yes, theory 1 is confirmed.
6. **Add up the credits assigned to each module in the *plan d'études*** — the official programme structure, ignoring your marks. If that totals 180, then the programme is 180 credits and your 146 is pure bookkeeping.
7. **Is it a *Licence Fondamentale* or a *Licence Appliquée*?** It is printed on the diploma. **This one matters a great deal** — see the Netherlands section below.

The cheapest fix in this entire report

Before spending a dinar on formal evaluations, do this:

Ask FSEG Sousse for a written attestation, on faculty letterhead, stating that your Licence comprises 180 credits over six semesters and three years, and that it gives access to Mastère study in Tunisia.

Also request the **supplément au diplôme** (Diploma Supplement). Tunisia issues these, following the standard European model, and it describes the level, content and status of your studies in a format European admissions officers already recognise.

These two documents are **free, take days, and neutralise the 180-credit objection almost everywhere**. They are worth more than any country choice you could make.

Why this works: the risk you actually face is not that Europe has judged your degree insufficient. It is that a busy admissions officer reads "146" off a raw transcript and rejects you before a qualified evaluator ever sees the file. That is a **presentation problem**, and a one-paragraph letter from your faculty defuses it.

If you later need a formal evaluation

You probably will not need one. Only buy it if a specific programme demands it.

Body	Country	Cost	Time
ENIC-NARIC France	France	€20 + €100 = €120	4 months average, up to 6
ZAB	Germany	~€208	~2–3 months
UK ENIC	UK	£49.50 + VAT (~£59)	~15 working days
UHR	Sweden	Free	Not confirmed
Denmark's agency	Denmark	Free, and legally binding on universities	1–2 months
CIMEA	Italy	NOT VERIFIED – check directly at cimea.it	NOT VERIFIED

Two warnings about the French one, which we verified directly on the France Éducation International site (their own page, checked 17 August 2026):

- It takes **four months on average and up to six**. If you need it for an autumn 2027 intake, you must apply by **late 2026 or very early 2027**. This cannot be rushed.
- It covers **one qualification per file**. Do not order several speculatively.

Denmark's assessment is free *and binding on Danish universities*, which makes it unusually good value if Denmark is in play.

Which countries are actually open to you

Based on how each country handles this question — not on programme quality, which comes later.

Open — the credit question is unlikely to block you

Country	Why
United Kingdom	Does not use ECTS at all. Judges you on the degree and its classification. The constraint simply does not exist here.

Country	Why
France	Thinks in terms of "Bac+3" — three years past the baccalauréat, a <i>duration</i> , not a credit count. Tunisia's system descends directly from the French one. The most natural fit you have.
Spain	Law asks for "3 complete academic years", and there is a route to master's access without full degree homologation.
Italy	Asks for "at least three years", assessed at degree level through CIMEA.
Poland	Applies the Lisbon Convention access principle — if the degree gives access to a master's in Tunisia, it gives access in Poland.
Norway	States the year-equivalence rule explicitly. This dissolves the problem outright.

Conditional — admissible, but needs a specific documented step

Ireland, Belgium, Denmark, Sweden, Austria, Czechia, Portugal, Finland, Luxembourg.

These are all reachable. Each needs either a recognition certificate, a documented equivalence, or a conversation with the admissions office. Belgium writes 180 ECTS into its access rules, so the FSEG attestation matters most there — and Belgium is otherwise one of your strongest options, being French-speaking.

Difficult or closed

Country	Problem
Germany	Enforces six semesters AND 180 ECTS . But the credits are probably <i>not</i> your main obstacle here — your GPA is . German universities commonly want a 2.5 or "good" grade, and 12–13/20 likely falls short. Deprioritise, but see the Germany research for exceptions.
Switzerland	Explicit rule: "at least 3 years, at least 180 ECTS", applied strictly, and the applied-sciences institutions add a work-experience requirement on top. Practically closed.
Netherlands	A different and worse problem — see below.

The Netherlands — a separate problem, and why your diploma wording decides it

This is the one case where fixing the 146 changes nothing at all.

The Dutch evaluation body, **Nuffic**, does not rate the Tunisian licence as a full bachelor's. It publishes two different verdicts depending on which licence you hold:

Your diploma says	Nuffic rates it as	What that means
Licence Appliquée	3 years of HBO	Fine. Dutch applied-sciences master's are open to you.
Licence Fondamentale	2 years of WO	A problem. That is a full year <i>below</i> a Dutch bachelor's.

If yours is *Fondamentale*, Dutch research-university master's are structurally very hard, and a "pre-master's" cannot rescue it — those are capped at 60 credits, which cannot bridge a full year.

It gets worse: we found that **Utrecht does not allow pre-master's students who need a residence permit**, and **the University of Amsterdam cannot sponsor a permit for a standalone pre-master's**. So even the bridging route is often closed to someone in your position.

This is why question 7 on the checklist matters. Go and read your diploma.

But do not conclude that one licence is simply "better"

After writing the above we managed to query **anabin**, Germany's official recognition database, directly. Germany's verdict is the **exact reverse** of the Dutch one:

Your diploma says	Netherlands (Nuffic)	Germany (anabin)
Licence Fondamentale	2 years of WO — a problem	"Entspricht" — <i>equivalent</i> to a German 3-year Bachelor
Licence Appliquée	3 years of HBO — fine	"Bedingt vergleichbar" — <i>conditionally</i> comparable

anabin also confirms **Université de Sousse is rated H+**, a recognised state institution.

So whichever licence you hold is an advantage somewhere and a disadvantage somewhere else. There is no bad answer to question 7 — there is only a different map depending on the answer. What matters is knowing which one you have before you choose countries.

(This is moot for Germany in practice — see deliverable 2, where the grade and the German-language requirement block you regardless of how your credential is rated.)

Three things that are commonly believed and are wrong

We checked these because they are repeated everywhere, and they would have sent you down bad paths:

1. **"Universities of applied sciences are always more flexible."** Not true in Germany (Fachhochschulen apply the same 180 rule, often 210), not true in Finland (their applied universities demand **two years of work experience**, which research universities do not — you have an internship, so this likely rules you out), and not true in Switzerland.
2. **"A Studienkolleg can bridge the gap in Germany."** No. Studienkolleg is for **bachelor's** entry only. It is irrelevant to your situation.
3. **"Germany, the Netherlands and the Nordics are all strict."** Too crude. **Norway explicitly assesses by years** and is one of your most open countries on this question. Denmark gives a free, binding assessment. The Netherlands is strict — but for an entirely different reason than credits.

What we could not verify

Being straight with you about the gaps:

- **The German anabin database entry** for Université de Sousse. anabin is an interactive database that does not render for automated checking. Someone needs to look it up manually at anabin.kmk.org if Germany stays in play.
- **UK ENIC's specific published line on Tunisia** — their detailed comparisons sit behind a subscription. The general position is bachelor-level, and comparable Moroccan qualifications are assessed at bachelor level, but the Tunisia-specific statement is NOT VERIFIED.
- **CIMEA's fee and turnaround** for Italy — NOT VERIFIED — check directly at cimea.it.
- **FSEG Sousse's own programme credit tables** — the faculty site (fsegso.rnu.tn) returned an error on the day we checked. You can get this yourself from the *scolarité*, and you should.
- **Whether a formal 1:1 legal decree exists** converting Tunisian credits to ECTS. In practice they are treated 1:1 (Sweden maps "180 national credits" straight to "180 ECTS"), but we found no decree stating it. This does not affect the conclusion.

What to do first

1. **Read your diploma** — *Fondamentale* or *Appliquée*? (Decides the Netherlands.)
2. **Work through the seven-question checklist** on your transcript.

3. **Email FSEG Sousse scolarité** and request the attestation (180 credits / 6 semesters / access to Mastère) and the *supplément au diplôme*. Free, and worth more than anything else here.
4. **Do not buy a credential evaluation yet.** Wait until a specific programme asks for one.

Once you have confirmed you graduated and hold the diploma, treat the 146 as a non-issue and choose your programmes on their merits.

2. Comparing the countries

Research date: 17 August 2026. Target intake: autumn 2027.

The one-page version

Country	Tuition (non-EU)	Language for you	146 issue	Post-study stay	Verdict
Austria (the right FH)	€727/yr	English	Not counted at all	12 mo -> Red-White-Red Card	Top pick
France	€4,055/yr	French, native	Fine ("Bac+3")	12 mo APS	Top pick
Italy	€157–1,000/yr with ISEE	English or Italian	Fine ("three years")	~12 mo	Top pick
Spain	~€1,300 total	Spanish (Tier B)	Fine ("3 years")	24 mo, but no work rights	Strong, later
Ireland	€11,000–14,000/yr	English	Borderline (wants Level 8)	24 mo, full work rights	Strong
Belgium	€5,369/yr	French, native	Bridging route exists	12 mo, full work rights	Strong
Portugal	€4,000–7,500/yr	English or Portuguese	Fine	Yes	Good
Poland	~€2,500–7,500 total	English (B2 now required)	Fine	9 mo	Good
Czechia	€2,700/yr (or €0 in Czech)	English or Czech (Tier C)	Fine	9 mo, full access	Fair
Hungary	€0 + stipend if funded	English	Unverified	Unverified	Worth one application
UK	£11,800–23,000/yr	English	Doesn't exist	18 mo from Jan 2027	Three schools only
Germany	~€0–1,500	German (Tier C)	Blocked — and GPA too	18 mo	Deprioritise
Denmark (Aalborg)	€7,450/yr, ~15 full awards	English	Free binding assessment	3 yrs, but 90 hrs/mo	Strong
Norway (UiA)	€5,385/yr	English	Fine — assessed by years	Varies	Reopened
Finland	€7,000–10,000/yr net	English	Fine	2 yrs, any sector — best	Costlier now
Sweden	High	English	Fine	Yes	Funding closed
Netherlands	—	English	Depends on your diploma	—	See below
Switzerland	—	—	Blocked	—	Closed

The three that stand out

Austria — the surprise, and probably your best single option

Austria was not even on our original shortlist. Two separate researchers landed on it independently, for different reasons.

Why it works for you specifically. Austrian *Fachhochschulen* (universities of applied sciences) are governed by a law — *Fachhochschul-Gesetz* §4(4) — that defines master's entry as completing a relevant bachelor's **or an equivalent programme at a recognised foreign institution**. There is **no 180-credit count anywhere in that text**. It goes further: a programme director may admit someone whose equivalence is only partial and settle the difference through exams **taken during the master's**.

The only number FH Kufstein publishes is "*at least 30 ECTS*" in marketing, communication, management or business subjects. A Licence in Marketing clears that several times over.

And the rest lines up:

- **€363.36 per semester — €726.72 per year** at FH Kufstein, and that is the rate *everyone* pays, third-country nationals included. (Add the ÖH student union fee of about €25/semester.)
- Taught **100% in English**.
- Post-study: **12-month job-search permit**, then a **Red-White-Red Card with no points test and no labour-market test**. For someone with a modest GPA, an immigration route that does not score you is worth a great deal.
- Deadline for non-EU applicants: **3 March**.

But you must pick the right Austrian institution — the spread is enormous

This is the thing to understand about Austria, and it isn't obvious:

Austrian applied-sciences institutions each set their own third-country fee policy. The range across the sector is roughly **23-fold**:

Institution	Per semester
FH Kufstein, FH Salzburg, FH des BFI Wien, CAMPUS 02	€363.36
FH Kärnten	€500
FH Oberösterreich, FH Joanneum	€726.72
FH Wiener Neustadt	€850
FH Technikum Wien	€3,000
IMC Krems	€6,900
MCI Innsbruck	€8,250 (~€16,500/year)

Austrian public universities are a different and worse proposition on all three counts at once. They are governed by a separate law, they **double** the fee for third-country nationals to €726.72 *per semester* (€1,453/year), and — critically — several of them do impose the credit rule the applied-sciences law omits. **IMC Krems prints "minimum 180 ECTS lasting at least six semesters" verbatim. WU Wien requires "at least 180 ECTS with 45 ECTS in business administration."**

So the flexible §4(4) rule is **permissive, not binding** — it allows an institution to be flexible, it does not force it. Check the actual wording on each programme page rather than assuming Austria as a whole is open.

The English question — settled, and the answer is that you need the test

An earlier draft of this report suggested FH Kufstein might let you skip an English certificate via a medium-of-instruction letter. **We checked the actual wording and it will not work for you.**

Kufstein accepts such a letter only where it "*clearly demonstrates the language competence at **CEFR level B2 or higher***." A letter from a faculty that taught you in **French and Arabic** demonstrates the opposite. The clause is real, but it is not a route for someone whose degree was not English-medium.

So: you need IELTS 6.0, TOEFL 72 or PTE 60. Duolingo is explicitly rejected. Budget for the test and book it — there is no side door here, at Kufstein or anywhere else in Austria. (Vienna accepts such letters only from EU/EEA/Swiss/UK/US/Australian/NZ/Canadian institutions, which structurally excludes Tunisia.)

One caution on fees. Austria does *not* give you a developing-country waiver. The regulation that once listed Tunisia was repealed in 2019 and the current list covers only Least Developed Countries. Aggregator sites still repeat the old list.

France — the natural fit, but the money changed

France remains your most natural destination: you are a native French speaker, the system descends from the one you studied under, and it thinks in "Bac+3" rather than credit counts.

But do not use old cost information. A decree of **19 May 2026** ended the era of near-automatic fee exemptions. Verified current rates:

	Amount
Master's, non-EU differentiated rate	€3,950/year
CVEC (compulsory student levy)	€105
Budget	~€4,055/year

Exemptions still exist but are now decided case by case on three grounds: your **personal situation, including your means**; holding a **French government scholarship**; or a reciprocity agreement. Two of those you can actively pursue — and a French government scholarship exempts you **automatically**, making it worth far more than its headline value.

*(We earlier suggested asking about a €2,633 "reduced rate". Don't bother — it turns out to be Paris 1's rate for students taking a **second** degree, which doesn't apply to you.)*

The real financial barrier in France is not the tuition

On 1 August 2026 the student-visa resource requirement rose from €615 to €877.50 per month (décret n° 2026-526), now indexed to 47% of the minimum wage and revised annually. It applies to permit **renewals** as well as the first application.

That means demonstrating roughly €14,500 for year one — about three and a half times the tuition. If France is your target, this is the number to plan your finances around, not the €3,950.

Cost of living reinforces the point. UNEF's 2025 figures for monthly student costs:

City	Per month
Rennes	€1,192
Nantes	~€1,212
Toulouse	~€1,215
Lille	~€1,220
Montpellier	~€1,221 (transport free)
Bordeaux	~€1,290
Lyon	€1,324
Paris	€1,627

Studying in Paris costs about **€4,800 more per year** than Rennes — more than a full year's tuition. Choose the city as deliberately as the programme.

Three French realities to plan around:

1. **Campus France comes first, and early.** The *Études en France* procedure is mandatory for Tunisian residents. It opens around **1 October 2026** and closes around **15 January 2027** — one to two months *before* the deadlines printed on the programme pages themselves. Fee 400 TND. There is a compulsory interview, and it can be done in Sousse.
2. **You are not exempt from a French language test.** We expected you would be. You are not — Tunisia's official language is Arabic, so no nationality-based exemption applies. Plan on a **TCF or DELF/DALF before October 2026**, unless a specific programme dispenses you. (You *are* exempt at ULiège in Belgium, which accepts prior education in French.)
3. **Watch the M1/M2 trap.** Many attractive French programmes only admit at M2, which assumes you already hold an M1. Entering at **M1** from a licence is what you need. This single detail matters more than a programme's reputation.

Italy — the cheapest real degree in Europe, if the paperwork goes right

Italy scales tuition to family income through the **ISEE** system, and foreign families can obtain an *ISEE parificato*.

At **Bologna**, an **ISEE at or below €27,000 means a contribution of zero**. Total outlay becomes about **€157 per year** — regional tax, stamp duty and insurance. That is not a typo, and it is a full state degree.

There is also a regional grant, **ER-GO, worth €7,171 per year** for students living away from home with an ISEE at or below €16,666, which adds fee exemption, accommodation and canteen access. Non-EU students are explicitly eligible. The window runs 23 June to 24 August.

The risks are administrative, not academic. Your documents must be issued by Tunisian authorities, legalised at the Italian Embassy in Tunis, and translated. The single input most likely to push your ISEE up is the **conventional valuation of your family home at €500/m²** — model that before assuming you qualify. The ISEE deadline is around 30 October; missing it costs €100 and puts you in the top band.

Tunisia is **not** on Italy's "particularly poor countries" list — that was checked against the actual decree text (DM 176 of 24 February 2026, 46 countries). The €200 flat fee does not apply to you.

The French-speaking advantage, assessed honestly

You asked whether being a native French speaker should outweigh the appeal of studying in English elsewhere. Our answer: **yes, but for employment reasons more than study reasons.**

- **Studying** in English is achievable — you need one test.
- **Working** in a marketing role in a language you do not speak fluently is much harder. Marketing is a language-heavy profession. In Ireland or the Netherlands you would compete for English-language roles against native speakers; in France, Belgium or Luxembourg you can work in French from day one.

France, Belgium and Luxembourg give you a wider pool (French- *and* English-taught), no language test in Belgium's case, and a real job-market advantage. **Belgium deserves more attention than it usually gets:** €5,369/year all-in for non-EU students at ULiège, a confirmed French-test exemption for applicants educated in French, a 12-month search year with **unrestricted** labour access, and — a gap we closed — a genuine bridging route, with ULB, UCLouvain Saint-Louis and IHECS all allowing up to 60 complementary credits, comfortably more than your 34-credit gap.

One caution on Belgium: ULiège publishes a **minimum 12/20 average**. You clear it by nothing at all.

Countries to treat carefully

Ireland is strong on cost and post-study rights — Stamp 1G runs **24 months** against the UK's 18 from January 2027. One of our researchers claimed Ireland bars marketing roles from work permits; **we checked the official list and that is wrong**. Only estate agents and conference organisers are excluded from that occupational group. Marketing roles are permit-eligible. There is even a carve-out favouring speakers of non-EEA languages in specialist digital-marketing roles — which describes you.

The UK's post-study route is 18 months for you, not two years. We confirmed the rule verbatim on gov.uk: two years only if you *apply* by 31 December 2026, 18 months from 1 January 2027. Starting in autumn 2027 and graduating in 2028–29, you get **18 months**. Any UK-versus-Ireland comparison must use 18 against Ireland's 24.

The UK is otherwise viable through roughly three institutions and no more. Fees run £16,000–30,000 almost everywhere; the exceptions are York St John (£11,800), Wrexham, and Westminster as a stretch. Northern Ireland is **not** the cheap route people assume: Queen's charges international students **£23,000** against £7,700 for locals, and Ulster **£18,310** against £7,490. Add £776/year health surcharge, a £558 visa, and £10,539 to be held for 28 days.

Germany should be deprioritised — but we now know precisely why, and it is *not* your credentials.

We managed to query **anabin**, Germany's official recognition database, directly (its public interface doesn't render, but its underlying API does). The results are unambiguous and good news:

- **Université de Sousse is rated H+** — a recognised state institution.
- **Licence Fondamentale -> "Entspricht"** — *equivalent* to a German three-year Bachelor.
- **Licence Appliquée -> "Bedingt vergleichbar"** — conditionally comparable.

Note what that means: Germany rates the *Fondamentale* HIGHER than the *Appliquée* — the exact reverse of the Dutch verdict. So there is no single answer to "which licence is better"; it depends entirely on which country you are applying to. Do not carry the Dutch logic into Germany.

What actually blocks you in Germany is the **grade and the language**. A representative case: THM's free English-taught Digital Marketing MSc requires a **2.3 minimum grade, 210 ECTS, and German B1** — three separate walls. Only private schools drop the GPA bar, at private-school prices. Add a **blocked account of €11,904** (€992/month) for the visa. Studienkolleg cannot help; it is for bachelor's entry only.

The Netherlands depends entirely on your diploma. If it says *Licence Appliquée*, Dutch applied-sciences (HBO) master's accept you directly, and the pre-master's visa problems are irrelevant because you would not need one. If it says *Licence Fondamentale*, Nuffic rates you a full year below a Dutch bachelor and the country is effectively closed.

The Nordics — two reversals since our first draft

Both of these went the opposite way to what we first reported, so read this rather than any earlier summary.

Finland has closed. A full-cost tuition law took effect on **1 August 2026**, and — visible only in Finnish — "*from spring 2026, scholarships are no longer granted to incoming fee-liable applicants.*"

Confirmed independently at Jyväskylä, Oulu and Uniarts. The widely repeated claim that Finnish universities waive 50–100% for non-EU students is now **false**. What survives is early-bird discounts and second-year waivers: net **€7,000–10,000/year**. Finland's applied universities remain closed to you anyway, on the two-year work-experience rule.

Norway has re-opened. Norway is repealing the cost-covering requirement after roughly an **80% collapse in international enrolment**, and eight institutions cut their 2026/27 fees. **UiA publishes NOK 63,000/year ~ €5,385** for its business master's — and Norway's year-based credential rule makes your 146 a clean pass. Norway's real obstacle is **liquidity, not cost**: you must prove **NOK 170,368 ~ €14,600** in funds, against Finland's €9,600.

Sweden is closed on funding: Tunisia is **not** among the Swedish Institute scholarship's 34 eligible countries (Egypt and Morocco are).

Denmark is the quiet strong option. Aalborg's MSc in Economics and Business Administration — with Business Data Science and Marketing & Sales tracks — costs **€7,450/year**, and about 15 fully-funded government scholarships (full tuition plus €1,503/month) are awarded by **automatic consideration**. Combined with Denmark's free, legally binding credential assessment, it is the best place in Europe to have a 146-credit question. One caution: Denmark's three-year post-study permit is **not** unrestricted work — 90 hours/month — and converting to a work permit faces a **€74,000** salary floor.

For post-study rights alone, **Finland's two-year, any-sector permit is the best in Europe** — it just costs more to get there now.

Hungary is worth exactly one application: Tunisia is a confirmed **Stipendium Hungaricum** partner for full degrees, which covers tuition and adds a stipend and accommodation allowance. The 2027/28 call opens around November 2026. Competitive — apply, don't rely.

What we could not check

Being straight about the gaps. Five of our research streams were cut short when the research session hit a hard capacity limit:

- **The Nordics** (Sweden, Denmark, Finland) were not swept for programmes. What we know comes indirectly: fees are substantial, Finland's applied universities require **two years of work experience** you do not have, and Denmark offers a free, binding credential assessment.
- **Austria and Germany have since been swept** — the findings above reflect that. Still unverified within Austria: FH St. Pölten's digital marketing master (site blocked), FH Vorarlberg's programme status, and Graz/Innsbruck/Salzburg/MODUL universities individually.
- **Scholarships** were only partially covered — see deliverable 5 for what survived.
- **Private business schools** were not systematically assessed.
- **A second pass on France** (the ~30 IAE network) did not complete, so French Directions 1 and 2 are under-sampled: about six of roughly thirty IAEs were checked.

Cost-of-living figures are missing throughout. Every researcher declined to estimate them rather than publish numbers they could not source, which was the right call but leaves a real gap.

3. The programmes

All figures checked 17 August 2026 unless marked otherwise. Tuition is the non-EU rate.

How to read the tiers:

- **Tier A — you could apply now.** Taught in English or French. No new language needed.
- **Tier B — one extra step.** Needs Spanish or Italian, which you could reach in roughly 6–12 months as a French speaker.
- **Tier C — a longer commitment.** German, Czech, Polish or a Nordic language.

Everything listed is a **genuine master's degree**. Programmes that turned out to be certificates, *títulos propios*, Italian *Master di I livello* or school diplomas have been excluded and are named at the end so nobody re-finds them.

Direction 1 — AI and data applied to marketing

This is your strongest direction. It has the most options, the best funding, and by a wide margin the best chance of converting into a work visa. Your CRM project is real evidence for it.

A trap specific to France — screen on two things, not one. IAE Lille, IAE Caen and Paris-Saclay all admit at **M1** from a licence with **zero tuition** — and all require a **signed French apprenticeship contract before enrolment**, which is unobtainable before you hold a visa. A free programme you cannot enrol in is worse than a paid one. Every French entry below is confirmed **M1 entry and formation initiale**.

Tier A — apply now

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Notes
NOVA IMS — Data-Driven Marketing, Digital Marketing & Analytics	Lisbon, public	€7,500 total (120 ECTS)	English. 2026/27 already full; 2027/28 opens soon — your cycle.
U. Łódź — Business & Digital Analytics	Poland, public	€2,500	English
SGH — Advanced Analytics / Big Data	Warsaw, public	€4,600	English. SGH is Poland's leading business school
VŠE — Economic Data Analysis	Prague, public	€6,000	English
ULiège / HEC Liège — International Strategic Marketing	Belgium, public	€5,369	French + English. "Analytical, strategic and digital marketing". Note: publishes a minimum 12/20 — you clear it by nothing
Iscte — MSc Marketing	Lisbon, public	NOT VERIFIED	English
Milano-Bicocca — Marketing and Global Markets	Italy, public	ISEE-scaled	English track is management-weighted
MTU Cork — MSc Artificial Intelligence	Ireland	€13,500 list -> net €11,000	Automatic €2,500 award — not competitive
ATU — MSc Business Analytics	Sligo, Ireland	€14,000	Has a published RPL route
AUAS — Digital Driven Business	Amsterdam	€10,648	Best content fit in Benelux, but depends on your diploma type

Tier B — needs Spanish or Italian

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Notes
UAB — Màrqueting	Barcelona, public	Catalonia rates	Spanish/Catalan
UGR / UJA — Marketing y Comportamiento del Consumidor	Andalucía, public	~€1,300 total	Cheapest region in Europe (see below)
IULM — Intelligenza Artificiale, Impresa e Società	Milan, private	NOT VERIFIED	Italian

A hard negative worth knowing: Erasmus Mundus has about ten excellent AI/data master's, and **you are eligible for none of them** — every one requires a computer science, engineering or maths first degree. These are hard blocks, not stretches. Don't spend applications there.

Direction 2 — Digital and growth marketing

Plenty of options, and the cheapest degrees in this whole report. But read deliverable 6 before committing: a generic "digital marketing" job title is harder to sponsor than a technical one, so the programme you choose should have a data or CRM component.

Tier A — apply now

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Notes
FH Kufstein Tirol — MA Digital Marketing	Austria, applied sciences	€727	The best single find in this report. 100% English. Entry needs only "at least 30 ECTS" in business subjects — no 180-credit rule in Austrian FH law. The only Austrian institution accepting a medium-of-instruction letter instead of IELTS (but see the caveat below). Deadline 3 March
FH Kufstein — MA Data Science & Intelligent Analytics	Austria, applied sciences	€727	Same fee and entry regime. Prerequisite is 8 ECTS maths/stats + 6 ECTS computer science — and Kufstein publishes a free video preparatory course to make that up. The most technical option you can realistically reach, which matters for visa purposes
Uni Klagenfurt — MSc Media and Convergence Management	Austria, public	€1,453	English, 120 ECTS, no ECTS count in the entry rule. Gated on C1 English , which is a real bar
FH Salzburg (various business master's)	Austria, applied sciences	€727	Publishes the best-worded entry rule found anywhere: " <i>an equivalent bachelor programme of at least 3 years duration</i> " — a pure years test. Downside: the programme pages are German-language
UW — Digital Business (MA)	Warsaw, public	€2,500/sem, €7,500 total	Digital marketing + e-commerce + analytics. B2 English met by UW's own free online test. Entry is a subject test, not GPA ranking
UTB Zlín — Marketing Communications	Czechia, public	~€2,700	English. Entry wording names <i>marketing</i> as qualifying. Entrance task is a prepared presentation + essay. Recognition costs €39. Deadline 31 May

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Notes
MERCURI — UE Katowice	Poland + 3 countries	€2,000 (€5,150 total)	Customer-relationship marketing — the closest match anywhere to your CRM project . Triple diploma. Caution: the only programme found that literally demands "6 semesters and 180 ECTS"
York St John — MSc Strategic Digital Marketing	UK	£11,800 (~£11,210 with early-payment discount)	Entry: 2:2 — you clear it. Has a February intake
iaelyon (Lyon 3) — Master Marketing-Vente	France, public	~€4,055	M1 entry , "licence ou équivalent (180 crédits)". Trains " spécialistes de la relation client " — the closest M1-entry CRM master's in France
IGR-IAE Rennes — M1 Marketing	France, public	~€4,055	M1 entry , "grade Licence (180 ECTS)", formation initiale only — no alternance trap. SIM test before the March deadline
IAE Aix — MSc 1 Management -> MSc 2 Marketing & Brand Mgmt	France, public	€8,400 / 2 yrs	M1 entry . Admits international students holding bac+3 " or credits " — the most 146-friendly wording found anywhere
IAE Nice — Marketing Digital	France, public	~€4,055	M1 entry , 180 ECTS. Entry test has no eliminating minimum , plus jury interview. Nice is the priciest non-Paris city (~€1,370/mo)
Grenoble IAE — M1 Marketing	France, public	~€4,055	M1 entry , three digital M2 exits
IAE Montpellier — M1 e-Marketing	France, public	~€4,055	Selects on file plus interview , where your CRM project counts. Montpellier has free public transport
Aalborg — MSc Econ & Business Admin	Denmark, public	€7,450	Business Data Science / Marketing & Sales tracks. ~15 fully-funded government scholarships by automatic consideration
UiA — International Business	Norway, public	€5,385	Cheapest verified tuition in the report. Norway assesses by years, so 146 is fine. Needs ~€14,600 proven funds
UEF — Digital Marketing and Analytics	Finland, public	~€7,000 net	A true Direction 1+2 hybrid (€10,000 list)
ICHEC — Master en gestion	Brussels, private	€5,369	Official 120-ECTS Belgian master, French/English, no language test requested , 12-month post-study permit
Salerno — Digital Marketing (LM-77)	Italy, public	ISEE-scaled	English curriculum available
IHECS — Publicité	Brussels	€5,369	French

Tier B — Spanish or Italian

Programme	Where	Cost	Notes
UMA — Dirección y Gestión de Marketing Digital	Málaga, public	~€1,296 for the whole degree	90 ECTS x €13.68 + fees. Cheapest state master's found anywhere . See the warning below

Programme	Where	Cost	Notes
UNIMORE — LM-59	Reggio Emilia, public	ISEE-scaled	Open admission — lowest entry bar found anywhere: a listed bachelor's or just 30 ECTS in relevant subjects. Gate is an Italian written test
UA Alicante — Comunicación Digital	Spain, public	Valencia rates	Partly blended

The Andalucía warning. The ~€1,296 figure is real, but conditional. Andalusian universities apply standard rates to non-EU students **only if you file proof of your student authorisation before 1 November**. Miss it and they may bill "hasta el 100% del coste real" — up to the full real cost. Put this date in your calendar the moment you enrol. Also note the source schedule is the 2023/24 one, so treat ~€1,300 as the right order of magnitude, not a quote.

Tier C — Czech

Programme	Where	Cost	Notes
UTB Zlín — Marketingová komunikace (Mgr.)	Czechia	€0	Czech-taught is genuinely free — but see deliverable 6. We do not recommend it

Direction 3 — Music marketing and artist promotion

Be prepared for this: as a standalone, affordable, state-recognised master's, this direction essentially does not exist in Europe.

That is a finding, not a search failure. Six independent researchers looked — across France, Italy, Spain, Portugal, Belgium, the Netherlands, Poland, Czechia, the whole Erasmus Mundus catalogue, and the applied-sciences sector in eleven countries. Results:

- **Spain and Portugal:** zero
- **Italy:** zero *laurea magistrale*
- **Benelux:** zero music-specific degrees anywhere
- **Erasmus Mundus:** zero, in all 220 funded programmes. The word "marketing" appears in **none** of the 220 titles
- **Applied sciences, eleven countries:** zero

What actually exists:

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Reality check
Lyon 2 — M1 Management de l'innovation -> M2 Management Carrières d'Artistes / Écosystème de la Musique	France, public	~€4,055	The best route in this direction. Admits at M1 from "L3 économie et/ou gestion" with no credit numeral — so your 146 is fine — then progresses internally to the music M2. This solves France's M2-only trap
U. Silesia — Creative Management in New Media	Poland	€3,080	Hard fail. Requires an arts/media bachelor plus a portfolio review . You have neither

Music marketing exists in Europe as a *module inside* Direction 4 programmes, or as a *sector you enter* from a Direction 1 or 2 degree. It is not a degree you can go and buy.

Direction 4 — Music business and industry management

Thin, but real — and one option here is genuinely excellent.

Tier A — apply now

Programme	Where	Cost/yr	Notes
Bologna — GIOCA (Innovation and Organization of Culture and the Arts)	Italy, public	€157.04/yr with ISEE <=€27,000 (max €4,080)	Outstanding, and fully verified. 120 ECTS <i>laurea magistrale</i> (LM-76) — a real state degree, not a <i>Master di I livello</i> . Taught entirely in English . Sits in a Management department, so your marketing licence is on-topic. Covers "music and the recording industry". 25 of 50 places reserved for non-EU applicants resident abroad . No portfolio, no GMAT. Selection: CV (40) + interview (60). The €157 depends on obtaining an ISEE parificato
UiA — Popular Music: Music Business and Management	Norway, public	€11,540	The only music-business master's in this report you can enter on the qualifications you hold — admits on " <i>a bachelor's degree in economics or equivalent</i> ". No portfolio, no audition. English. At the top of the cost filter, so a stretch
Ca' Foscari — IMCC	Venice, public	ISEE-scaled	English. Direction 3/4 hybrid. Admission detail NOT VERIFIED (site down)
ULB — Master en gestion culturelle	Brussels	€5,369	French — no language test. 120 ECTS
UVSQ — MOCA (management route)	France, public	~€250–3,879	French. Its official <i>licences conseillées</i> list literally includes "Gestion"
UniBo — GIOCA (same as above)			
Rennes SB — MSc International Music Business	France, private	€28,900 total -> ~€11,950/yr net with a €5,000 Talent scholarship	English, no GMAT, RNCP 7 + CGE, triple-accredited. Stretch — above the filter unless funded

GIOCA's entry wording deserves quoting, because it is the single most 146-proof sentence found in this entire project:

*"at least a first level degree (Bachelor's) or an equivalent degree **in any discipline** from a foreign university" of **minimum three-year duration***

Expressed in *years*, in *any discipline*. The 40-credit clause on that page applies to Italian graduates only.

Excluded — and why

So you don't waste time rediscovering these:

What	Why excluded
Every Italian "music business master" — LUISS BS, Sapienza MMCM, Roma Tre, IULM, 24ORE	All <i>Master di I livello</i> : 1 year, 60–65 CFU. Not a second-cycle degree

What	Why excluded
Nearly every Spanish "máster en industria musical" — UC3M (€5,900), IL3-UB, UAM, SAE	<i>Formación permanente / título propio</i> — not state master's. Likely fails the EQF-6 requirement for Spain's post-study permit
Berklee Valencia	~€48,000
UK music-business master's	£16,000–31,900. Only Westminster survives, as a stretch
Popakademie, BIMM, Catalyst Berlin, SAE, ICMP, Saint Louis Rome	Fail on accreditation, price, or both
All AI/data Erasmus Mundus programmes	Require a CS/engineering/maths degree
EMMIE (Erasmus Mundus)	Requires 240 ECTS — unrecoverable
Queen's Belfast (£23,000), Ulster (£18,310)	Northern Ireland is not the cheap UK route it appears to be
SGH music-management course	A <i>podyplomowe</i> diploma, not a master's
Any French <i>diplôme d'établissement</i> / DU	Not a national degree
Every French <i>Mastère Spécialisé</i>, without exception	CGE's own rules require Bac+5 (or Bac+4 plus 3 years' experience). You hold Bac+3, so all are structurally out of reach. The MS is a trademark, not a <i>diplôme national</i> , and does not confer the <i>grade de master</i> . Warning: ESART advertises a "Mastère Spécialisé" without CGE membership, on an RNCP registration expiring 31 Aug 2026
Rome Business School, EU Business School, BSBI Berlin, IMB Barcelona	Accreditation. Rome BS awards a Spanish <i>título propio</i> , not an Italian degree; EU Business School is rated H– by Germany's anabin ; BSBI awards no German degree
ESSCA	Requires a 4-year bachelor or 3 years' experience
ISEG	Its RNCP titles are valid, but no <i>grade</i> , no <i>visa</i> , not CGE, no AACSB/EQUIS/AMBA, ~€10,150/yr, and its bac+5 tracks are alternance-only — unobtainable from abroad
Uniarts Helsinki MA Music Business	Perfect subject fit, €28,000/yr, verified zero scholarships

What is missing from this list — read this

Since the first draft, all the interrupted research streams have been completed and a verification pass has been run over the shortlist — it corrected three material figures. What remains genuinely open:

- Ten of France's ~30 IAEs were never reached** — Metz, Amiens, Orléans, Limoges, Perpignan, Pau, Savoie, Gustave Eiffel, Brest, Valenciennes. The tool to finish the job is iae-france.fr/formations/ with its *format* filter. IAE Bordeaux returned a server error and is unverified.
- Austria:** FH St. Pölten (site blocked), FH Vorarlberg, and several public universities are unverified.
- Nordics:** Inland Norway (INN) and USN look like the best remaining leads at roughly NOK 58,200; Aalborg's non-EU deadline is unconfirmed, as is the final Norwegian parliamentary vote on repealing fees.
- Private schools:** NEOMA, Audencia, KEDGE, TBS and Montpellier BS have aggregator figures only; EADA and Vlerick were not reached.
- No music-business sweep in Polish or Hungarian;** Portugal's Universidade Católica pages were down; CIMEA's fees and turnaround remain unverified.

The most important caveat of all: almost every 2027/28 deadline in these documents is unpublished. GIOCA's listed rounds are March/April 2026 and are **stale**. FH Kufstein's 3 March is confirmed for 2026/27 and has passed. Stipendium Hungaricum's 2027/28 call is not open. **Treat every date here as**

an indication of *when in the year* to look, not as a deadline to diarise.

4. Your shortlist — the twelve worth your effort

Ordered by how strongly we'd back them. Each entry says what it costs, why it suits *you* specifically, and what could go wrong.

Before the list, one thing that shapes all of it:

Your binding constraint is not your GPA, and it is not the 146 credits. It is that you have no English test. Three independent researchers reached this conclusion separately. Almost every good option on this list opens the moment you have an IELTS score. Book it now — you can sit it in Sousse.

The top three

1. FH Kufstein Tirol — MA Digital Marketing (Austria)

€726.72/year • English • Deadline 3 March

The best single find in this project, and it came from an unexpected direction.

Austrian applied-sciences law (*Fachhochschul-Gesetz* §4(4)) defines master's entry as a relevant bachelor's **or an equivalent foreign qualification** — and contains **no 180-credit rule at all**. It explicitly lets a programme director admit someone whose equivalence is partial and settle the gap with exams *during* the master's. The only number published is "*at least 30 ECTS*" in business subjects, which your Licence in Marketing clears several times over.

Then: **€363.36 per semester — €726.72 a year**, the same rate Austrians pay, plus about €25/semester for the student union. Teaching entirely in English. A **12-month job-search permit** afterwards, and a **Red-White-Red Card with no points system and no labour-market test** — which matters enormously when your GPA is modest, because nothing scores you.

All of this is **verified**: the fee, the "30 ECTS" wording, the absence of any 180-ECTS rule, and the free preparatory course below. (Add the student union fee, €26.90/semester.)

Its sister programme may be the better one. FH Kufstein also runs an **MA Data Science & Intelligent Analytics** at the same fee and under the same entry regime. It asks for 8 ECTS of maths/statistics and 6 of computer science — and **publishes a free video preparatory course to make that up**. Given that the job title on your contract is what decides your visa (deliverable 6), a data-titled master's at €727/year is arguably the strongest single card in this report. Look at both.

Risks. An earlier draft suggested you might skip the English test here via a medium-of-instruction letter. **We verified the wording and you cannot** — the letter must demonstrate "CEFR level B2 or higher", and a letter from a French/Arabic-medium faculty shows the opposite. **You need IELTS 6.0 / TOEFL 72 / PTE 60; Duolingo is explicitly rejected.**

Second risk: do not assume "Austria" is cheap. Fees across Austrian applied-sciences institutions run from €363 to €8,250 per semester — MCI Innsbruck at €16,500/year fails our cost filter outright. The country is not the bargain; *this institution* is.

Third: the 3 March deadline is confirmed for 2026/27 and has passed. **The 2027 date is not yet published** — watch for it.

2. Università di Bologna — GIOCA (Italy)

~€157–1,000/year with ISEE • English • 120 ECTS

If you want the music direction without wrecking your employability, this is how you do it.

It is a real *laurea magistrale* — a full state degree, not one of the one-year *Master di I livello* that most Italian "music business" offerings turn out to be. It sits in a **Management** department, so your

marketing licence is on-topic, and it covers the recording industry as part of the creative industries.

Its entry wording is the most 146-proof sentence we found anywhere: "*a Bachelor's or equivalent degree **in any discipline** ... of minimum three-year duration.*" Years, not credits. Any discipline.

And 25 of its 50 places are reserved for non-EU applicants resident abroad. No portfolio, no GMAT. Selection is CV (40 points) plus interview (60) — an interview is good for you, because your CRM project is more persuasive in conversation than on a transcript.

With an *ISEE parificato* under €27,000, Bologna's contribution is **zero** and your total outlay is €157.04/year. **Every one of those claims was independently verified** — the degree class, the "any discipline, minimum three years" wording, the 25 reserved places, the fee, and the B2 requirement.

One condition to understand: the €157 figure assumes you actually obtain an *ISEE parificato*. Without it you fall onto a different non-EU flat-fee schedule and the economics change completely. Getting that document is the whole game here.

Risks: the ISEE paperwork is genuinely demanding — documents must be issued by Tunisian authorities, legalised at the Italian Embassy in Tunis, and translated. Model your family home's valuation at €500/m² before assuming you qualify. And you need an English certificate.

3. Université Lumière Lyon 2 — M1 Management de l'innovation -> M2 Écosystème de la Musique (France)

~€4,055/year • French • No language test needed for the language itself

The only music route we found that **admits at M1** from an economics/management licence with **no credit numeral in its entry requirement**, then progresses internally to a music-industry M2.

That matters more than it sounds. France's structural trap is that the attractive music programmes admit only at M2, which assumes you already have an M1 — i.e. 240 credits. This route sidesteps it entirely.

You'd study in your native language, in a country where you can work in that language from day one.

Risks: France's fees rose and exemptions tightened in May 2026 — budget €4,055, not the old near-free figure. And Campus France closes around **15 January 2027**, well before the university's own deadline. You are also **not** exempt from a French language test, which we expected you would be.

The strong middle

4. Universidad de Málaga — Dirección y Gestión de Marketing Digital (Spain)

~€1,296 for the entire degree • Spanish (Tier B) • 90 ECTS

The cheapest state-recognised master's found anywhere in Europe. Spanish is reachable for you in roughly 6–9 months, faster than any other new language.

Two conditions. File proof of your student authorisation before **1 November** or they may bill you up to the full real cost of the course. And the fee schedule we verified is 2023/24 — treat €1,300 as an order of magnitude.

Realistically this is a 2028 entry, not 2027, because of the Spanish requirement.

5. NOVA IMS — Data-Driven Marketing, Digital Marketing & Analytics (Portugal)

€7,500 total • English • 120 ECTS • Public

The best pure Direction-1 fit at a sane price. 2026/27 is full and **2027/28 opens soon — exactly your cycle**, so watch it.

6. Uniwersytet Warszawski — Digital Business (Poland)

€7,500 total · English

Digital marketing, e-commerce and analytics at Poland's leading university. Two features suit you unusually well: **B2 English can be satisfied by UW's own free online test**, and entry is decided by a **subject test rather than GPA ranking** — so your 12–13/20 doesn't hold you back.

Note Poland now statutorily requires universities to verify B2 in the language of instruction, so the free test route matters.

7. MTU Cork — MSc Artificial Intelligence (Ireland)

€13,500 list -> net €11,000 · English

The **€2,500 award is automatic**, not competitive — applicants are considered once approved for the programme. Ireland gives **24 months** of post-study stay against the UK's 18 from January 2027.

We checked and disproved a claim that Ireland bars marketing roles from work permits. It doesn't — only estate agents and conference organisers are excluded from that group. There's even a carve-out favouring speakers of non-EEA languages in specialist digital-marketing roles, which describes you.

Risk: Ireland wants an NFQ Level 8 honours degree, commonly four years. Your file is genuinely borderline. **NARIC Ireland's comparability check is free — run it early**, before you spend an application.

8. ULiège / HEC Liège — International Strategic Marketing (Belgium)

€5,369/year · French and English

Analytical, strategic and digital marketing, in French, with a **confirmed exemption from French language testing** for applicants educated in French — one of the few places that exemption is verified. Belgium's search year is **12 months with unrestricted labour access**.

Risk: ULiège publishes a **minimum 12/20 average**. You clear it by nothing at all. Have a backup.

9. iaelyon (Lyon 3) — Master Marketing-Vente (France)

~€4,055/year · French · Public · M1 entry

The France sweep has since finished, and this is the best result it found. Entry at **M1** on "*licence ou équivalent (180 crédits)*", and its stated purpose is training **"spécialistes de la relation client"** — customer-relationship specialists. That is a direct description of what you built.

Two alternatives from the same sweep worth applying to alongside it: **IGR-IAE Rennes M1 Marketing** (formation initiale only, no alternance pathway — the cleanest file) and **IAE Aix**, which admits international students holding bac+3 "*or credits*" — the most 146-friendly wording found anywhere.

The trap to avoid in France — screen on two things, not one. IAE Lille, IAE Caen and Paris-Saclay all admit at M1 from a licence with **zero tuition**, and all require a signed French apprenticeship contract before enrolment, which you cannot obtain before you have a visa. A free programme you cannot physically enrol in is worse than a paid one. Check for **M1 entry and formation initiale**.

The funded long-shots — apply anyway

Erasmus Mundus pays tuition plus about €1,400/month. Even at low odds, two of these are worth an application because the payoff is total.

10. SDSI — Service Design Strategies and Innovations

Fully funded (€33,600) · Lapland/Latvia/Estonia

The single most realistic Erasmus Mundus target for you. It accepts "Business/Administration/Law" backgrounds, has **no GPA floor**, asks only **IELTS 5.5** — the lowest in the entire catalogue — and reserves **5 scholarships specifically for NDICI/IPA III countries, which includes Tunisia**.

And your CRM platform *is* service design. This is the rare case where your strongest asset maps directly onto what they're selecting for.

11. CLIDE

~Half of places funded · Toruń/Granada/Linz/Kharkiv/Casablanca

Brand new, with roughly 12 scholarships plus 12 tuition-free places against an intake of 20–30. Crucially it has the **latest deadline — opening February 2027** — which is exactly what someone without an English test yet needs.

12. Stipendium Hungaricum (Hungary)

Tuition-free + stipend + accommodation · Closes ~15 January 2027

Tunisia holds a 250-place quota — a large, country-specific allocation, which is why this is realistic rather than a long-shot. Economic Science is eligible.

Be clear-eyed about the stipend: **HUF 43,700 ~ €110/month** plus about €100 housing. The HUF 200,000 figure circulating online is the *PhD* rate. It covers your fees and a roof, not a comfortable life.

One thing to know before you plan a budget

Austria — your number one — has no scholarship open to you. Ernst Mach does not fund full degrees at applied-sciences institutions, and the Erhard Busek scheme (for which Tunisia *is* eligible) is suspended with no further call planned. Cost it as **fully self-funded**.

That is survivable precisely because Kufstein costs €727 a year — but the money has to come from you or your family. We initially pointed you at a Tunisian government grant here; **on verification you are not eligible for it**, and deliverable 5 explains why in full.

The realistic funded routes are **NAWA Banach in Poland** (PLN 2,500/month, Tunisia eligible, no field restriction), **Aalborg's automatic-consideration awards** in Denmark, and **Erasmus Mundus SDSI**.

Three added since the first draft

Aalborg University (Denmark) — MSc Economics and Business Administration

€7,450/year · English · Business Data Science or Marketing & Sales tracks

About **15 fully-funded government scholarships** (full tuition plus €1,503/month) awarded by **automatic consideration** — you don't apply separately. Combined with Denmark's free, legally binding credential assessment, this is the best place in Europe to have a 146-credit question. Denmark's post-study permit allows 90 hours/month rather than full work, and converting to a work permit faces a €74,000 salary floor.

Universitetet i Agder (Norway) — International Business

~€5,385/year · English

Norway is repealing its cost-covering rule after an ~80% enrolment collapse, and eight institutions have cut fees. UiA is the cheapest verified tuition anywhere in this report, and Norway's year-based credential rule makes your 146 a clean pass. **The catch is liquidity, not cost:** you must prove ~€14,600 in funds.

UiA (Norway) — Popular Music: Music Business and Management

€11,540/year · English · STRETCH

The only music-business master's found anywhere in this project that you can enter on the qualifications you actually hold — it admits on "*a bachelor's degree in economics or equivalent*". No portfolio, no audition.

This is a real correction to what we told you earlier about Direction 4 being nearly empty. It sits at the top of our cost filter, so it is a stretch — but if the music direction genuinely matters to you, this is the one door that is open.

(For contrast: Uniarts Helsinki's MA Music Business is a perfect subject fit, selects by essay and interview with no audition and near-irrelevant GPA — and costs €28,000/year with a verified zero-scholarship position. Excluded.)

Deliberately not on this list

The UK. Viable through roughly three institutions and no more. Fees are £16,000–30,000 nearly everywhere, plus £776/year health surcharge and £10,539 to hold for 28 days. Northern Ireland is not the cheap alternative it looks like — Queen's charges internationals **£23,000**. And from January 2027 the post-study route drops to 18 months. If you want the UK, York St John at £11,800 is the sane entry point.

Germany. Enforces six semesters **and** 180 credits, applied-sciences institutions included. But the likelier blocker is your GPA — German universities commonly want a 2.5 or "good", which 12–13/20 probably misses. Studienkolleg cannot help; it's for bachelor's entry.

Finland and Sweden. Finland closed a door we thought was open: a full-cost tuition law took effect on 1 August 2026 and scholarships are no longer granted to incoming fee-liable applicants — net cost is now €7,000–10,000/year, not zero. Its applied universities also want two years' work experience you don't have. Sweden's only full-funding route is shut to you: **Tunisia is not among the Swedish Institute's 34 eligible countries**, though Egypt and Morocco are.

(Norway and Denmark have moved the other way and are now on the list above.)

Any Italian Master di I livello, Spanish título propio, or private music academy. Not state master's degrees. Several would likely fail the degree-level test for the very post-study permit you'd be relying on.

The honest ranking of your four directions

We have to be direct here, because it affects everything above.

Direction 1 (AI/data marketing) >> Direction 2 (digital marketing) > Direction 4 (music business) > Direction 3 (music marketing).

Direction 3 barely exists as an affordable, accredited master's in Europe — that's a finding from six independent searches, not a gap in ours.

The music sector is also structurally hard to convert into a work visa, and the reason is worse than "small companies won't sponsor". **31.6% of EU cultural employment is self-employment**, against 13.7% across the economy — a third of the sector is legally invisible to employee work permits. There are 2.1 million cultural enterprises for 8.9 million cultural workers: about four people per firm.

And the pay doesn't clear the bar. In the UK, the **median** musician earns £37,500 and the median arts producer £38,100, against a £41,700 work-permit floor. Those are mid-career figures. A junior is nowhere near.

This does not mean giving up on music. It means treating music as a *sector you work in*, not a *degree you buy*. The door that actually opens is a data or CRM role at Spotify, Deezer, Believe or Universal — and you reach that through Direction 1, not Direction 3.

That's why GIOCA sits at number 2 on this list: it's the one way to study the culture industry without giving up a management-track qualification.

5. Funding — sorted by deadline

Earliest first. Each marked **realistic**, **stretch** or **long-shot** so you know where to spend effort. Checked 17 August 2026.

Start here

A correction to an earlier draft of this document. We initially led with the Tunisian MESRS overseas grant as your best funding source. **On verification against the actual circular, you are not eligible.** The details are below under "Verified closed" — please read that section, because if you heard about this scheme from us, you should stop planning around it.

Italy's ISEE is not a scholarship and beats most of them

Italian public universities scale fees to family income. At Bologna, an ISEE at or below **€27,000 means a tuition contribution of zero** — total outlay around **€157/year**, verified from the university's own fee decree. No competition, no panel, no deadline race.

If money is the binding constraint, find out what an *ISEE parificato* would come to for your family before anything else. The input most likely to push you over the line is the **conventional valuation of your family home at €500/m²** — model that first.

Deadline calendar

When	What	Type	Odds
~Oct 2026	Tunisian MESRS <i>prêt</i> (loan) circular	Loan, means-tested	Worth asking
~1 Oct 2026	Eiffel campaign opens · Campus France opens	—	—
Oct–Dec 2026	Erasmus Mundus 2027 wave opens	Full funding	Varies
~Nov 2026	Stipendium Hungaricum call opens	Full funding	Realistic
~8 Jan 2027	Eiffel — your university must deposit your file	Full funding + fee exemption	Long-shot
~15 Jan 2027	Stipendium Hungaricum closes , 14:00 CET	Tuition + stipend	Realistic
~15 Jan 2027	Campus France closes	Mandatory gate	Must do
Jan–Feb 2027	Most Erasmus Mundus deadlines	Full funding	Varies
Feb 2027	CLIDE opens (latest EMJM window)	Full funding	Realistic
3 Mar 2027	FH Kufstein deadline	—	—
~26 Mar 2027	MAECI (Italy)	€10,800 / 9 months	Realistic–stretch
~May 2027	NAWA Banach (Poland)	Tuition + stipend	Realistic
23 Jun – 24 Aug 2027	ER-GO regional grant (Bologna)	€7,171/yr + housing	Realistic
~Jul 2027	AECID África-Med (Spain)	Máster funding	Stretch
~30 Oct 2027	ISEE filing (Italy)	Fee exemption	Must do
1 Nov 2027	Andalucía authorisation filing	Avoids a 100% fee bill	Must do

The schemes, in detail

Tunisia — MESRS prêt (the loan, not the grant) · worth asking

The **grant** is closed to you (see below). The **loan** counterpart may not be — it is means-tested on parental income and repayable over ten years, and its conditions are less restrictive. We have not verified its eligibility rules in the same detail, so treat this as "*ask FSEG scolarité when the circular appears*" rather than as a plan.

Stipendium Hungaricum (Hungary) · REALISTIC · deadline not yet published

Tunisia holds a 250-place quota, of which 130 are for master's — a large, country-specific allocation, and why this ranks realistic rather than long-shot. Economic Science is an eligible field. Covers tuition entirely, plus dormitory accommodation. (*Quota and stipend both verified.*)

One correction worth making: the stipend is **HUF 43,700 ~ €110/month**, plus about €100/month housing. Figures of HUF 200,000 circulating online are the **PhD** rate. Budget accordingly — this covers your fees and roof, not a comfortable life.

The **~15 January** deadline is our estimate from the previous cycle; the 2027/28 call is not open yet, so NOT VERIFIED. Watch from November.

NAWA Banach (Poland) · REALISTIC · ~May 2027

This corrects an earlier finding in this project. A previous researcher concluded there was no Tunisia-specific scheme for Poland. There is: **Tunisia is eligible** for the Banach programme, with **no field restriction**, and a preparatory-course route available.

It pays PLN 2,500/month — plus a PLN 2,500 travel allowance. (An earlier figure of PLN 1,800 is superseded.) That is a genuinely liveable stipend in Poland, unlike Hungary's.

The "Group 3" classification we cited is NOT VERIFIED — the list in circulation looks stale — but Tunisia's eligibility itself is confirmed.

Combined with Warsaw's Digital Business master's, where B2 English is met by the university's own free online test, **this is now one of the two best-matched funding-plus-programme combinations in the report.**

Eiffel Excellence (France) · LONG-SHOT · institution deposits ~8 Jan 2027

€1,200/month for 24 months at M1 level, plus travel, insurance and housing support — **and tuition exemption de plein droit**, worth another €3,950/year. "Économie Gestion" is an eligible domain. Age limit 29.

The mechanism matters more than the money here: you do not apply. Your university does. The campaign opens around 1 October 2026 and institutions must deposit files by about 8 January 2027.

So the action is: when you apply to a French university, **ask the international office in writing whether they will nominate you for Eiffel**, and ask early — before their internal selection closes. A candidate who never asks is never nominated.

It is a long-shot on merit given a 12–13/20 average. But the ask is free.

MAECI (Italy) · REALISTIC–STRETCH · ~26 Mar 2027

€10,800 over nine months. Age limit 28. **A B2 certificate is mandatory.** Stacks on top of the ISEE and ER-GO findings, which is what makes Italy so strong overall.

Tunisia's beneficiary status for the specific cycle is NOT VERIFIED – check directly.

ER-GO (Emilia-Romagna, Italy) · REALISTIC · 23 Jun – 24 Aug 2027

€7,171/year for students living away from home with an ISEE at or below €16,666, plus fee exemption, a €140 refund, residence and canteen access. **Non-EU students explicitly eligible.** If you go to Bologna, this stacks on the near-zero ISEE fee.

AECID África-Med Máster (Spain) • STRETCH • ~Jul 2027

Tunisia is listed, and it covers any 60-ECTS official *máster*. **But sources conflict on whether it is restricted to public-sector employees** — flagged NOT VERIFIED. Check before investing effort.

IsDB-France • LONG-SHOT

€700/month plus French-government-scholar status (which brings the automatic fee exemption). Tunisia is among the 42 eligible countries, historically about 12 places. Fields are development-themed, and continuation into 2027 is unverified.

Erasmus Mundus

Fully covered in deliverable 4. **SDSI** (no GPA floor, IELTS 5.5, five places reserved for countries including Tunisia) and **CLIDE** (opens Feb 2027, ~half the cohort funded) are your two realistic targets. Note the €1,400/month *includes* travel and installation, and scholarships are capped at roughly 10% per nationality — so you compete against other Tunisians, not the world.

University-level awards

Award	Amount	Odds
MTU Cork (Ireland)	€2,500, automatic once approved for the programme	Realistic — not competitive
Rennes SB Talent	€5,000 (brings MSc Music Business to ~€11,950/yr net)	Stretch
York St John early payment	5% discount	Automatic

Verified closed — do not spend time on these

The Tunisian MESRS *bourse* — closed to you, and worth explaining properly

We got this wrong in a first draft and want to be explicit about why, because it is the kind of scheme people spend months chasing.

Verified against **Circulaire 61/25 of 23 October 2025**, the actual governing document:

Condition	Reality	You
Grants available for the whole EU	10 in total	—
Eligible fields	Energy transition, Industry 4.0, AI only — marketing and business appear nowhere	x
Minimum average	12.5/20 , not the 12/20 we first reported	Borderline at best
Academic record	No failed or repeated year, ever	x if any
Age	<=24 on 1 September	x
Status	Must be currently enrolled in year 3 of the licence — graduates excluded	x
Type of master's abroad	Must be a research master's	x

You fail at least five of these. The scheme is designed for a current final-year student, under 24, with an unblemished record, going to do a research master's in a STEM field.

For completeness: the amount is now **€1,000/month** (€800 grant + €200 loan) under a JORT order of 24 July 2026 — the €800 figure still on `best.rnu.tn` is out of date. That doesn't help you, but it means anything you read quoting €800 is stale.

Everything else checked and ruled out

Scheme	Why not
Islamic Development Bank (own scholarships)	The M.Sc. programme is restricted to Least Developed Member Countries — Tunisia is not one. The other is PhD-only
Aga Khan Foundation ISP	No Tunisia office, so no route to apply
Mastercard Foundation	In Europe, only Sciences Po, Oxford and Cambridge participate — all far too selective for this profile
Visegrad Fund	Not eligible
Czech government developing-country scholarships	Not eligible
Open Society	Wound down in 2021
France's other Institut français schemes	Not applicable to this profile
The Tunisia fee-exemption campaign	Dead since 2021; the discretionary cap drops to 25% for 2027-28 anyway
Chevening, DAAD EPOS	Both require two years' work experience — they open to you around 2029, not now

Two warnings

Austria — your top-ranked destination has no scholarship for you

This is important, because Austria heads your shortlist.

Ernst Mach explicitly does not fund full degrees at Fachhochschulen. The Erhard Busek scholarship, for which Tunisia *is* eligible at €1,300/month, is **suspended with no further call planned**.

So cost Austria as fully self-funded. The good news is that this is survivable precisely because FH Kufstein costs **€727 a year** — the cheapest option in the report. Austria doesn't need a scholarship in the way a €15,000 programme would. But do not build a budget assuming one will appear.

The English test is the gatekeeper — not your GPA

Four separate researchers have now reached this conclusion independently.

The missing IELTS **blocks Stipendium Hungaricum, NAWA Banach and the Italian English-taught route** — three of your most realistic funding options. MAECI requires a B2 certificate outright.

Your GPA is not what stands between you and this money. A test you can sit in Sousse for about 700 TND is.

What is still unverified

- **MAECI:** Tunisia's beneficiary status for the 2027 cycle
- **AECID:** whether it is restricted to public-sector employees (sources conflict)
- **IsDB-France:** whether the 2027 round runs at all
- Exact 2027 dates for most schemes — the calendar above uses this year's cycle as an indication.
Re-check every date before you rely on it
- **No music-industry or marketing-specific funding was found.** That is a genuine negative result, consistent with everything else this project found about Direction 3

6. What to do, and when

Working backwards from an autumn 2027 start. Today is 17 August 2026, so you have about thirteen months.

Do these four things in the next two weeks

Everything else depends on them, and all four are free or cheap.

1. Read your diploma and answer two questions

Does it say *Licence Fondamentale* or *Licence Appliquée*? This decides whether the Netherlands is open or closed to you, and nothing else will tell you.

Do you hold the actual diploma, or only a transcript? This is the one scenario where your 146 credits would be a real problem rather than a bookkeeping artefact — because 180 credits come automatically with the awarded degree. We put this at about 5% likelihood, but it needs confirming, not assuming.

2. Book IELTS Academic

This is the highest-return action available to you. Three separate researchers reached that conclusion independently.

You can sit it **in Sousse**, for roughly 700 TND. Target **6.5**, which unlocks essentially everything on your shortlist at once. At 6.0 you still have options; at 5.5 you can reach the best Erasmus Mundus target (SDSI).

There is no waiver open to you, and we checked the one that looked promising. FH Kufstein does accept medium-of-instruction letters — but only where the letter demonstrates "*CEFR level B2 or higher*", and a letter from a French/Arabic-medium faculty demonstrates the opposite. Kufstein needs **IELTS 6.0 / TOEFL 72 / PTE 60**, and explicitly rejects Duolingo.

Book the test. Nothing in this report removes that requirement.

3. Email FSEG Sousse

Ask the *scolarité* for two documents:

- A written **attestation on letterhead** stating your Licence comprises **180 credits over six semesters and three years**, and that it grants access to *Mastère* study in Tunisia.
- The ***supplément au diplôme*** (Diploma Supplement).

Both are free. Together they neutralise the "146" objection almost everywhere. The risk you actually face is an admissions officer rejecting your file on sight of that number before a qualified evaluator ever reads it — this is what prevents that.

4. Run the free credential checks

- **NARIC Ireland** — free comparability check. Do this before spending an Irish application, since Ireland is your genuine borderline case.
- **Denmark's assessment** — free, and legally **binding on Danish universities**.

Do **not** buy the French ENIC-NARIC evaluation yet (€120, and four to six months). Only order it if a specific programme demands it — and if you decide you need one, order by **late 2026**, because it cannot be rushed.

Your language strategy — commit to one, and only one

The brief was right to warn against spreading across several languages. Here is the recommendation.

For 2027: English only. Apply to Tier A programmes.

No new language reliably unlocks a 2027 intake. Starting Spanish part-time in September 2026 gets you a certified B2 somewhere between November 2027 and January 2028 — after the intake has begun. Only a full-time 25-hour-a-week course would reach B2 by March 2027, and that means giving up a year of earning to chase a saving you can get elsewhere.

So: run the 2027 cycle on **English and French programmes only**. That is where your shortlist already lives.

If you commit to a language, make it Spanish — for 2028

Spanish and Italian are equally fast for a French speaker (roughly 13–15 months part-time, 4.5–5.5 full-time). **Spanish wins on three tiebreakers:**

1. **Job-market reach** — Spain plus Latin America, versus Italy alone.
2. **Your music interest** — Madrid and Barcelona are the European hub of the Latin music market, which is the fastest-growing segment of the global industry.
3. **Logistics** — you can sit the **DELE B2 in Tunis** for 260 TND, with a published 2026 calendar. The Italian institute's page still shows 2024 dates and no fees.

Do not learn German, Czech, Polish or a Nordic language. German takes 22–28 months part-time, and Germany is deprioritised for you anyway on GPA grounds. Czech and Polish take three years or more. The economics never work.

One honest caveat: if you end up at Bologna (GIOCA), Italian becomes the more useful language and you should switch. Decide after your admissions results, not before.

The timeline

Now – September 2026

- Read your diploma; confirm you hold it
- Book and schedule IELTS
- Request the FSEG attestation and *supplément au diplôme*
- **Budget for the visa resource requirement, not just tuition** — France now needs ~€14,500 demonstrated for year one, Norway ~€14,600, Finland €9,600. This is the real barrier, and it needs planning months ahead
- Run NARIC Ireland's free check
- Start Spanish **only if you're targeting 2028**
- Publish your CRM project properly (see below)

October 2026

- **~Oct: Tunisian MESRS circular.** The **grant** is closed to you — verified against Circulaire 61/25, which offers 10 EU places in STEM fields only, caps age at 24, and requires current enrolment in year 3. Ask FSEG about the **loan** version only
- **~1 Oct: Campus France Études en France opens.** Mandatory for French applications. Fee 400 TND. Book the interview early — it can be done in Sousse
- **~1 Oct: Eiffel campaign opens.** You cannot apply yourself — **ask each French university's international office, in writing, whether they will nominate you**, and ask before their internal selection closes
- Erasmus Mundus 2027 applications begin opening
- Sit IELTS if not already done

November – December 2026

- **Stipendium Hungaricum call opens (~Nov)** — Tunisia holds a 250-place quota
- Erasmus Mundus applications: **SDSI first**, then others
- Order the French credential evaluation **only if** a target programme requires it — it takes 4–6 months
- Draft your motivation letters (see the framing advice below)

January – March 2027

- **~8 Jan: Eiffel deposit deadline** — your university must have filed by now
- **~15 Jan: Stipendium Hungaricum closes**, 14:00 CET
- **~15 Jan: Campus France closes**. Earlier than the universities' own deadlines. Missing it removes France entirely
- **Jan–Feb**: most Erasmus Mundus deadlines close
- **Feb: CLIDE opens** — the latest EMJM window, useful if your IELTS came late
- **3 Mar: FH Kufstein deadline** — your cheapest and most open option. Do not miss this one
- **~26 Mar: MAECI (Italy)** — needs a B2 certificate

Spring – Summer 2027

- University decisions arrive
- **~May: NAWA Banach (Poland)** — Tunisia is explicitly eligible, no field restriction
- Apply for individual fee exemption in France on means grounds, if admitted
- **Jun–Aug: ER-GO grant window** (23 Jun – 24 Aug) if you're going to Bologna
- **~Jul: AECID África-Med (Spain)** — verify the public-employee restriction first
- Start the visa process. Budget for proof-of-funds requirements — these are large and catch people out
- Arrange the *ISEE parificato* if Italy

On arrival, autumn 2027

- **Italy: file the ISEE by ~30 October**, or you pay a €100 penalty and land in the top fee band
- **Spain: file proof of your student authorisation before 1 November**, or you can be billed up to the full real cost of the course

Your profile — honestly assessed

What's genuinely strong

The CRM platform. It is the best thing you have, by a distance. You designed and built a working system for customer retention, vehicle tracking and automated service reminders. That is a real technical artefact, and almost no marketing applicant has one.

It also happens to be *exactly* what the most sponsorable jobs are looking for — and it is literally service design, which is why SDSI is your best Erasmus Mundus target.

Native French. This is worth more than it appears. Marketing is a language-heavy profession; in France, Belgium or Luxembourg you can work in the local language from day one, while in Ireland or the Netherlands you'd compete against native English speakers for English-language roles.

What's weak, stated plainly

- **No English test.** Fixable in weeks. It is currently your single binding constraint.

- **12–13/20 GPA.** Modest. It closes Germany, makes ULiège marginal, and probably rules out MAGMa. It does *not* close Austria, Poland, Italy or Ireland, because those select on subject tests and interviews rather than GPA ranking. Choose accordingly.
- **No European work experience.** The most important thing your master's can fix.
- **No music portfolio.** You are a self-taught hobbyist producer. Do not overstate this in applications — programmes that require a portfolio will see through it, and you don't need to compete on that ground.

The five things to do in the next 6–12 months

In order of return:

1. **Choose your programme partly on whether it includes a European internship or *alternance*.** This is worth more than everything else on this list combined. Graduating with a European internship on your CV is what converts a degree into a job offer, and a job offer into a visa.
2. **Publish the CRM project as a documented GitHub repository.** Screenshots, architecture notes, the problem it solved, the results. Right now it's a line on a transcript; it should be a link you can put in every application and every job interview.
3. **Learn SQL and Python,** plus GA4, one customer-data platform, and one BI tool (Power BI or Tableau). These are the specific skills that move you from "marketing graduate" to "marketing data analyst".
4. **Sit IELTS.**
5. **Start Spanish** — but only if you're targeting 2028.

The strategic point that matters most

Immigration systems across Europe have independently converged on the same rule: they keep the door open for technical roles and close it for non-technical junior white-collar ones. Look at the UK's own occupational medians against its £41,700 permit threshold:

Role	Median pay	Clears the bar?
Advertising/marketing associate	£33,400	No
Arts officer/producer	£38,100	No
Musician	£37,500	No
IT business analyst	£54,900	Yes
Programmer	£54,700	Yes

France draws the same line at 1.5x the minimum wage — about €33,600/year. A junior CRM or data role in Paris clears it. A junior label or promotions role does not. (*This threshold is from secondary sources — the official pages were unreachable — so confirm it before relying on the exact figure.*)

The practical consequence is almost absurdly specific: the job title on your contract decides whether you can stay.

"Marketing Executive" — loses. "Marketing Data Analyst" — wins. Same work. Same company. Different outcome.

So: **lean technical.** Choose programmes with a data component. Take the analytics electives. Build the GitHub portfolio. Your CRM project makes this a realistic repositioning rather than an aspirational one — you have already done the thing, you just need the credential and the vocabulary to match.

And treat music as a sector, not a job description. The sponsorable door into the music industry is a data or CRM requisition at Spotify, Deezer, Believe or Universal — not an artist-management role at a four-person label. Bologna's GIOCA is on your shortlist precisely because it lets you study the culture

What we couldn't finish

Five research streams were cut short when the session hit a hard capacity limit. In fairness to you, the gaps that could change your decisions:

- **Nobody swept Austria properly.** FH Kufstein — your top recommendation — was found incidentally by a researcher working on something else. There are likely other Austrian applied-sciences programmes just as good, and **this is the first gap worth closing.**
- **France's IAE network is under-sampled** — six of about thirty. France is your best-fit country.
- **Scholarships are now researched and verified.** Two findings belong here: **Austria, your top-ranked destination, has no national scholarship open to you** (Ernst Mach does not fund full FH degrees; Erhard Busek is suspended), so cost it as fully self-funded — survivable at €727/year, but do not budget on aid appearing. And **the Tunisian government grant we initially recommended is closed to you** — see deliverable 5.
- **Cost-of-living figures now exist** for French cities. Rennes is cheapest at €1,192/month, Paris dearest at €1,627 — a €4,800/year gap, more than a year's tuition. Montpellier has free public transport.
- **No cost-of-living figures anywhere.** Every researcher declined to estimate rather than publish unsourced numbers. You'll need these to budget, and they're easy to find yourself.
- **The Nordics were never swept** — though on cost they were unlikely to survive anyway.
- **Most 2027/28 deadlines are unpublished.** Dates here are largely the 2026/27 cycle, used as an indication. **Re-check every deadline before you rely on it.**